

# EBRU EVCEN

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## EDUCATION

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**University of California San Diego**, San Diego, United States

2020 - July 2026

Ph.D. in Linguistics

*Dissertation title:* Conditional perfection and the role of alternatives: An experimental investigation in adult and child comprehension

*Committee:* David Barner, Ivano Caponigro, Caren Walker, Leon Bergen

**Middle East Technical University**, Ankara, Turkey

2016-2019

M.A. in English Language Teaching

**Middle East Technical University**, Ankara, Turkey

2012-2016

B.A. in English Language Teaching

## PUBLICATIONS

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### MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

**Evcen, E.** & Barner, D. (in prep). Imagining possible words and possible worlds in language acquisition.

### MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

**Evcen, E.** & Barner, D. (under review). Children spontaneously compute scalar implicatures.

**Evcen, E.** & Barner, D. (under review). Conditional reasoning in children: The role of context and alternatives.

### JOURNAL ARTICLES

Özge-Sarısoy, D., **Evcen, E.** & Hartshorne, J. (in press). Pronoun resolution in Turkish: The interplay of referential form, word order and implicit causality. *Cognitive Science*

**Evcen, E.**, Bale, A. & Barner, D. (2026). Conditional inference and access to alternatives: The role of QUD and speaker knowledge in conditional perfection. *Journal of Semantics*, flag003.

**Evcen, E.** & Barner, D. (2025). Already perfect: Language users access the pragmatic meanings of conditionals first. *Open Mind*, 9, 1098–1120.

Yeter, Ö., **Evcen, E.**, Rabagliati, H. & Özge, D. (2024). Understanding cognitive and language development in refugees: Evidence from displaced Syrian children in Turkey. *Cognitive Development*, 69, 101412.

### CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

**Evcen, E.**, Bale, A. & Barner, D. (2025). Which alternatives matter? The role of the Question Under Discussion and speaker knowledge in conditionals. *Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT)* 35, 65-83.

**Evcen, E.** & Barner, D. (2025). Preschoolers compute literal and pragmatic meanings of conditionals with contextual support. \*Peer-reviewed proceedings paper in *Proceedings of the 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Özge-Sarısoy, D., **Evcen, E.** & Hartshorne, J. (2025). Referential form, word order, and implicit causality in Turkish emotion verbs. \*Peer-reviewed proceedings paper in *Proceedings of the 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

**Evcen, E.** & Wittenberg, E. (2024). Two Negatives Make a Positive: Reducing Referential Uncertainty through Negation and Order Reversal Eases Processing in Counterfactuals. \*Peer-reviewed proceedings paper in *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 46.

**Evcen, E.** & Wittenberg, E. (2022). Making the Question Under Discussion explicit shifts counterfactual interpretation. \*Peer-reviewed proceedings paper in *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 44.

#### BOOK CHAPTERS

Özge, D. & **Evcen, E.** (2020). Referential form, word order and emotional valence in Turkish pronoun resolution. In U. Özge and D. Zeyrek (eds.), *Turkish Discourse, Structure and Meaning*. Trends in Linguistics Series, De Gruyter Publishing.

#### PRESENTATIONS

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**Evcen, E.** & Barner, D. (2026). Ice cream or cake? Free choice inferences and compatible possibilities. Poster at Cognitive Development Society Biennial Conference (CDS 2026), April 2026, Montreal, Canada

**Evcen, E.** & Barner, D. (2025). Spontaneous interpretation of disjunction in preschoolers: One is preferred, both are fine. Poster at the 49th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD 50), November 2025, Boston, MA, United States

**Evcen, E.** & Barner, D. (2025). Preschoolers compute literal and pragmatic meanings of conditionals with contextual support. Poster at the 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2025), July 2025, San Francisco, CA, United States

Sarısoy, D., **Evcen, E.** & Hartshorne, J. (2025) Referential form, word order, and implicit causality in Turkish emotion verbs. Poster at the 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2025), July 2025, San Francisco, CA, United States

**Evcen, E.** Bale, A. & Barner, D. (2025). Which alternatives matter? The role of QUD and speaker knowledge in conditionals. Poster at the 35th Semantic and Linguistic Theory (SALT 35), May 2025, Boston, MA, United States

**Evcen, E.** & Barner, D. (2024). Conditionally literal: Exploring conditional reasoning in children. Talk at the 49th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD 49), November 2024, Boston, MA, United States

**Evcen, E.** & Wittenberg, E. (2022). Two negatives make a positive: Reducing referential uncertainty through negation and order reversal eases processing in counterfactuals. Virtual poster at the 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2024), July, 2024, Rotterdam, The Netherlands.

**Evcen, E.** & Barner, D. (2024). Already Perfect: Conditional Statements. Poster at Experiments in Linguistics Meaning 3 (ELM 3), June 2024, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, United States

**Evcen, E.** & Barner, D. (2024). Conditional inferences are derived without delay. Poster at the 6th California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP 6), January 2024, Stanford University, CA, United States

**Evcen, E.** & Barner, D. (2023). Time course of conditional inferences. Poster at the 10th biennial meeting of Experimental Pragmatics (XPRAG 10), September 2023, Université Paris Cité – CNRS, Paris, France

**Evcen, E.** & Wittenberg, E. (2022). Negation facilitates comprehension of English counterfactuals. Short talk at Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP 28), September, 2022, University of York, United Kingdom.

**Evcen, E.** & Wittenberg, E. (2022). Making the Question Under Discussion explicit shifts counterfactual interpretation. Short talk at the 44th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2022), July, 2022, Toronto, Canada.

**Evcen, E.** & Özge, D. (2022). Pronoun resolution in Turkish Transfer-of-possession verbs: Evidence from comprehension and production. Talk at the 3rd Cologne Ankara Discourse Meeting (CADiM3), July 2022, University of Cologne, Cologne, Germany.

Özge, D., **Evcen, E.** & Hartshorne, J. (2022). Implicit causality biases in Turkish psychological state events. Talk at the 3rd International Conference on Prominence in Language (ICPL3), June, 2022, University of Cologne, Cologne, Germany.

**Evcen, E.** & Wittenberg, E. (2021). The Consideration of Alternatives During Incremental Comprehension of Counterfactuals. Short talk at Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP 27), September, 2021, Université de Paris, France.

Özge, D., **Evcen, E.** & Hartshorne, J. (2020). Referential form, word order and emotional valence in Turkish pronoun resolution. Poster at the 33rd Annual CUNY Human Sentence Processing Conference (CUNY), March, 2020, University of Massachusetts, Amherst, United States

**Evcen, E.**, Özge, U. & Özge, D. (2019). Turkish *unless* is not biconditional unless the pragmatic context allows it. Poster at the 8th Experimental Pragmatics Conference (XPRAG), June 2019, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, United Kingdom.

Özge, D., **Evcen, E.**, Kesici, A. & Köse, E. (2018). How do Turkish speakers interpret pronouns in Transfer-of-Possession contexts? Talk at the 14th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics (WAFL14), October, 2018, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA.

Özge, D., **Evcen, E.**, Kesici, A. & Köse, E. (2018). How do Turkish speakers interpret pronouns in Transfer-of-Possession contexts? Talk at the 2nd International Conference on Prominence in Language (ICPL2), July, 2018, University of Cologne, Cologne, Germany.

## TEACHING

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|                                               |             |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Instructor of Record</b>                   | Summer 2026 |
| <i>Department of Psychology, UC San Diego</i> |             |
| PSYC 190: Science of Parenting                |             |

|                                                                                |             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Instructor of Record</b>                                                    | Summer 2024 |
| <i>Department of Linguistics, UC San Diego</i>                                 |             |
| LIGN 170: Psycholinguistics: Experimental Approaches to Language and Cognition |             |

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>Graduate Teaching Consultant</b>                                                                 | Summer 2024 - Present |
| <i>Engaged Teaching Hub, Teaching &amp; Learning Commons, UC San Diego</i>                          |                       |
| Classes offered:                                                                                    |                       |
| Introduction to College Teaching: Foundations of Equitable Teaching (Fall 2024, Winter & Fall 2025) |                       |
| Advanced College Teaching: Equitable Course Design and Instruction (Winter 2026, Spring 2026)       |                       |
| Communication for Teaching (Spring 2025)                                                            |                       |

**Graduate Teaching Assistant**

2020 - 2024

*Department of Linguistics, UC San Diego*

LIGN 130: Semantics (Spring 2024) (2 sections)

LIGN 121: Syntax I (Winter 2024) (2 sections)

LIGN 101: Introduction to Linguistics (Winter 2020; Fall 2021; Spring 2021; Fall 2022; Winter 2022; Spring 2022; Fall 2023) (2 sections)

LIGN 8: Languages and Cultures of America (Fall 2020; Winter 2021)

**Language Instructor**

2016 - 2020

*Department of Foreign Languages, TOBB University of Economics and Technology***Mentorship***UC San Diego*

Ezgi Bayraktaroglu (Undergraduate Research Assistant)

Fall 2025 - Present

Kayla Moreno (Undergraduate Research Assistant)

Summer 2025 - Winter 2026

Grace Carlson (Undergraduate Research Assistant)

Fall 2025 - Winter 2026

Jessica Nieblas (Undergraduate Research Assistant)

Summer 2024 - Spring 2025

Raphael Dupa (Undergraduate Research Assistant)

Spring 2024 - Spring 2025

Katherine Jamison (Undergraduate Research Assistant)

Fall 2023 - Spring 2025

Victoria Hilke (Undergraduate Research Assistant)

Summer 2024

Vaidehi Bhavaraju (Undergraduate Research Assistant)

Fall 2023 - Spring 2024

Maansi Narain (Undergraduate Research Assistant)

Fall 2023 - Spring 2024

Priscilla Lin (Undergraduate Research Assistant)

Fall 2023 - Winter 2024

Ajax Asana (Undergraduate Research Assistant)

Spring 2022 - Fall 2023

Piper Mahn (Undergraduate Research Assistant)

Summer 2023

Miguel Mejia (Postbac Research Assistant)

Fall 2020 - Spring 2021

Lea Zaric (Undergraduate Research Assistant)

Fall 2020 - Spring 2021

**SKILLS AND INTERESTS**

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**Analysis & Tools:** R/RStudio and Quarto (statistical modeling, reproducible workflows, data visualization), Python (working knowledge), PsychoPy, PCIBex, Praat, GitHub, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X

**Languages:** Turkish (native), English (bilingual fluency), Southern Uzbek (fieldwork)

**GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS**

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**Grants**

Academic Senate General Campus Research Grant, UC San Diego

March 2023

*The Nature of Conditional Inferences* (PI: David Barner)

(\$12,000)

**Fellowships**

Anti-racist and Inclusive Pedagogy Fellowship, UC San Diego

Summer 2024 (\$500)

Summer Graduate Teaching Scholars Fellowship, UC San Diego

Summer 2024 (\$500)

National Scholarship Program for MA Students, Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey (TÜBİTAK)

2016–2019 (\$9,000)

Erasmus+ Grant for the Student Exchange Program, Turkish National Agency and European Union

2015 (\$2,000)

**Awards**

International Institute Research and Travel Award, UC San Diego

June 2026 (\$2000)

GPSA Travel Award, UC San Diego

November 2025 (\$400)

Distinguished Achievement in Service, Linguistics Department, UC San Diego

2024–2025

|                                                           |                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| GPSA Travel Award, UC San Diego                           | September 2023 (\$300) |
| Linguistics Department Travel Award, UC San Diego         | Summer 2023 (\$750)    |
| TA Excellence Award, Linguistics Department, UC San Diego | 2022-2023              |

## SERVICE

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### Institutional Service

Organizing Committee Member, California Meetings on Psycholinguistics (CAMP7), UC San Diego  
 Member, External Relations Committee, UC San Diego Linguistics  
 Editor, San Diego Linguistics Paper, UC San Diego  
 Member, Open House and Admissions Committee, UC San Diego Linguistics

### Ad-Hoc Reviews

Journal of Semantics; Language and Linguistic Compass; Cognitive Science Society Proceedings; Open Mind

## RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

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|                                                                                                                                                                                          |                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| <b>Language and Development Lab</b> , UC San Diego<br>PI: David Barner, Department of Psychology                                                                                         | 2021–present     |
| <b>Language and Meaning Lab</b> , UC San Diego<br>PI: Rachel Dudley, Department of Linguistics                                                                                           | 2025–present     |
| <b>Language Comprehension Lab</b> , formerly at UC San Diego; now at CEU<br>PI: Eva Wittenberg, Department of Cognitive Science                                                          | 2020–2022        |
| <b>SFB 1252 Prominence in Language</b> , University of Cologne<br>PI: Klaus von Heusinger, Department of Linguistics<br>Guest in C04: Conceptual and referential activation in discourse | June–July 2022   |
| <b>Language and Cognitive Development Lab</b> , Middle East Technical University<br>PI: Duygu Özge, Department of English Language Teaching                                              | 2017–2019        |
| <b>Language and Communication Development Lab</b> , Koç University<br>PI: Aylin Kuntay, Department of Psychology; Summer Undergraduate Research Program (KUSRP)                          | June–August 2016 |

## SUMMER SCHOOLS AND OTHER EDUCATION

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|                                                                                                                                                                |                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Student-Centered College Teaching &amp; Course Design</b><br>UC San Diego                                                                                   | March 2024        |
| <b>Seventh Summer School on Statistical Methods for Linguistics and Psychology</b> , Potsdam, Germany<br>Advanced methods in frequentist statistics with Julia | September 2023    |
| <b>Göttingen Fall School in Linguistics: Anaphora and Presuppositions</b><br>University of Göttingen, Göttingen, Germany                                       | August 2021       |
| <b>Study Abroad</b> , Keele University, Staffordshire, United Kingdom<br>TESOL (Teaching English to Speakers of Other Languages)                               | January–June 2015 |